Azhar Amir Kimanje

XR & AI Engineer

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Simplicity is Sophistication. I'm an XR and AI engineer with a unique perspective on improving multi-sensory cognitive decision-making in medical training and challenge-based education.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Interoperability Engineer · Exonicus Inc., Seattle, WA — Jun 2024 – Present

Real-time XR trauma simulation that trains combat medics to save lives.

- Integrated physiology engines, virtual patients, HLA and JETS under MOSA so simulations share one patient.
- Engineered a real-time medical data plugin, getting training to military medics **11 months** sooner.
- Optimized Unity DOTS for **thousands of medical injury combinations**; shipped MilExTS and Scenario Builder.

Director of Mixed Reality and AI Outreach · AVELA Non-profit, Seattle, WA — Jun 2024 – Present

Director of AI × XR Labs, bringing computing and XR education to underrepresented and rural students.

- Orchestrated XR programs reaching **3,200+ students a year**, with Gaussian splat worlds built from drone video.
- Led **3 PhD candidates and 6 interns** fine-tuning small language models with Apple MLX, shipping CourseSLM.
- Secured and executed a **$200K Apple CEI award** and an **$80K Apple grant** to scale on-device AI education.

Founder & CEO · Sablesync, Seattle, WA — Nov 2023 – Present

Spatial computing that anyone can use.

- Launched **four Apple apps** making 3D capture accessible: LiDAR scans, photo-to-USDZ and on-device reconstruction.
- Led **3 engineers** on real-time AR hardware links, cutting integration time **50%** and dev cycles **40%**.

Research Contributor · ISIA Lab (UMONS) · Morphic Lab (UW Tacoma) · LCI Lab (UW) — 2023 – Present

- Contributing to XR facial tracking (ISIA), reproducible bioinformatics (Morphic) and accessible coding (LCI).

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer, XR – Design Intelligence · IA Interior Architects — Jun – Sep 2024

- Created **10+ XR space plans** in Unity and Revit to test spaces before building, cutting project time **20%**.

Augmented Reality Developer, Extern · Snap Inc. — Mar – Apr 2024

- Designed Lens Studio AR experiences for sports businesses, winning **1st** in Snap's Master of AR program.

Software Engineering Intern, Product Management Intern · YouthForce — Jul 2023 – Jan 2024

- Won the Youthforce Coding Challenge, then led its first XR lounge: MVP **60%** faster at **120 fps**.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- **Hybrid Physical-Digital Training Environments for Combat Casualty Care.** First author, *Mil Med* (submitted).
- **Build, Train, Track: A Proposed Extended Reality Framework for Military Medical Experimentation.** Co-author, *Mil Med* (submitted).
- **From Toy to Tool: An Investigation on Student AI Use Cases and Effects.** Co-author. WEEF & GEDC 2026.
- **Tool or Toy? Student Views on ChatGPT in Culturally Responsive Computing Education.** IEEE, 2025.
- **Welcome to the Agentic Era: Strategic AI Implementation for Developers.** First author. Apple Education, 2026.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- **$3M+** in grants successfully executed, including a **$200K** Apple CEI award (2026).
- Workshop instructor and on-camera product demo, IMSH 2026.
- **1st** Place, UW Tech Showcase · **1st**, Snap Master of AR · **3rd of 200**, Global Eduhacks (2024).

SKILLS

Languages	C# (5+ years), Python (ML workflows: Gaussian splatting, Apple MLX), C++, Swift, C, SQL, Java
Spatial & 3D	Unity (DOTS), Unreal, OpenXR, RealityKit, ARKit, USDZ / OpenUSD, LiDAR, Gaussian splatting
AI & ML	MLX fine-tuning, small language models, on-device inference, computer vision, NLP
Simulation	HLA, JETS, MOSA, real-time data synchronization, CI/CD

EDUCATION

B.A., Computer Science and Engineering · Seattle Pacific University — 2020 – 2024